GOLD MASTER

BUDGET TAPE

PUBLISHER	PRICE	MACHINE	CONTROLS
Dalex Software	**£2.99**	**SPECTRUM 128K**	**Keys**

Ever wondered who keeps a software house running? Meet Mo, the producer, whose job is to get four games out of the door before Omnibot the courier robot gives up waiting. You trot the Design Doc to the desks, brew tea for coders whose mugs run dry, squash the bugs that drop out of Gareth's monitor and shoo Percy the office cat off whatever he's decided to sit on. Every stage done lights up the board, and when the shiny tape is ready you hand it to Omnibot before his dial runs out. It's a carry-'em-up in the spirit of Everyone's a Wally, with a busy office of folk on their own errands that owes a nod to Skool Daze. Seven rooms over three floors, four games to ship and a reviewer called Brian marking each one. Does it go gold?



▲ *Brian hands out 91% and a nod. Steady on, Brian, that's our job.*

KEV MALLIN

"Mo turns the instant you touch Q, A, O or P, and she stops dead when you let go, so steering her round the desks is never a chore. The fun is in juggling: a bug drops out of a monitor, the tea's running low and the cat's on the keyboard, all while Omnibot's clock ticks down. Leave it late and his dial flashes, he taps his foot and the tune shifts into a hurry-up version that had me sweating. Mind you, when Mo walks up to a seated coder she turns the seated coder white, which is a bit naff. Only four games to ship, mind. Worth a go."

KM

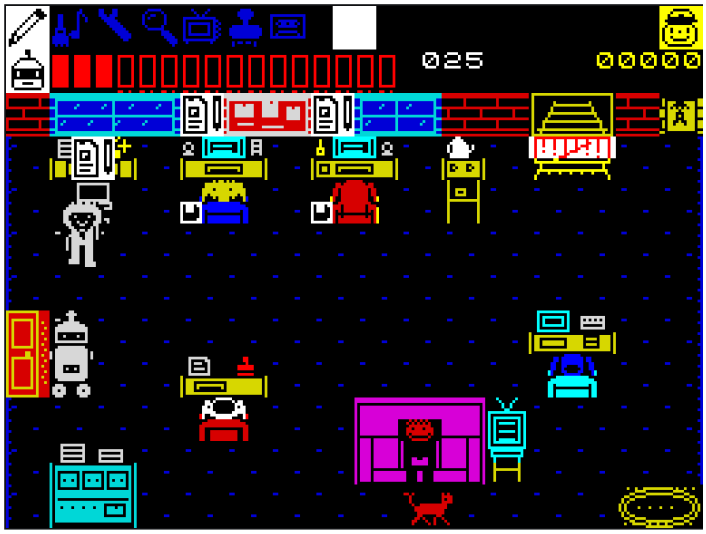
KEV SAYS **71%**

RUTH ASHDOWN

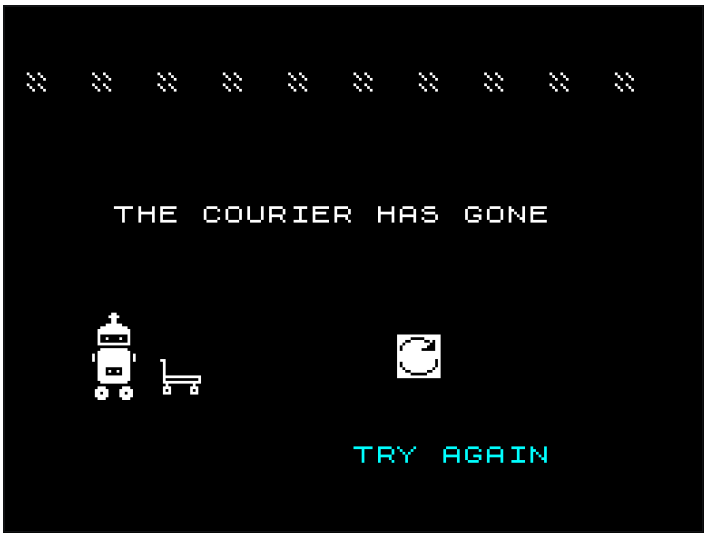
"What I like is how fair it is. Every nasty is shown before it costs you: a bug pokes out of the monitor first, Percy stretches before he plonks himself down, and the stop sign on the status strip shows a little picture of what's holding the work up. I shipped all four games with half the clock or more to spare, and Brian handed me 91% and a nod on the first one. There's a Relaxed mode with a teacup for the nervous, too. Some of the faces are another matter: the faces on the little game pictures and at the finale are hard to make out. Lovely value at £2.99."

RA

RUTH SAYS **76%**



▲ *The dial's gone red with 25 seconds to go. Get a move on, Mo!*



▲ *The courier has gone, but nobody shouts. Try again, with tea.*



▲ *All four games on the shelf and the whole office in a knees-up.*

STAN THORLEY

"Nearly four minutes to load, so put the kettle on, which suits the theme. The loading screen is a cheery picture of Mo striding through the office with Omnibot rolling up beside her. On the 128 you get a title tune, an office tune in play and little jingles for each stage and each shipment, with spot effects over the top, and M switches the music off if it gets on your nerves. The office is bright and tidy, though the white figures do clash with the coloured desks. Four games and you've seen the lot, and I wanted a few more. Decent, not dazzling."

ST

STAN SAYS **68%**

VERDICT

A friendly office juggle that's fair to a fault, let down by a little clash and a short shelf life. Not quite gold, but a shiny silver.

THE LOWDOWN

CONTROL KEYS	Q/A/O/P walk, SPACE puts down, H pauses, M music on or off, D picks the mode on the title
USE OF COLOUR	bright desks on black, with white figures that turn a coloured coder white when they meet
GRAPHICS	neat, chunky office furniture and a jolly cast; tiny faces can be a puzzle
SOUND	128K title tune, office tune with a hurry-up turn, jingles and spot effects
SKILL LEVELS	two: Deadline against the courier, or Relaxed with a cuppa
SCREENS	seven rooms over three floors, flip-screen, four games to ship
GENERAL RATING	a fair, friendly juggling act that's over a bit soon

THE RATINGS

PRESENTATION	**80%**
GRAPHICS	**71%**
SOUND	**72%**
PLAYABILITY	**75%**
ADDICTIVE QUALITIES	**65%**

OVERALL **72%**